

Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology

Professional Communication and Digital Media Studies (BA)

The major in "Professional Communication and Digital Media Studies" focuses students on the concepts, principles, theories, and practices of the communication discipline while helping them develop and master spoken, written, and visual communication skills applicable in several different employment arenas. While the B.A. in Professional Communication and Digital Media studies is essentially a generalist degree in the field of communication studies, it offers students the option of pursuing specialty concentrations in "Professional and Technical Communication" or "Digital Media Studies."

At least one-half of the total semester credit hours for major requirements must be taken at UT Dallas.

Unless otherwise noted, courses in Professional Communication and Digital Media Studies are open to all students in the University.

Bachelor of Arts in Professional Communication and Digital Media Studies

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

[COMM 1311](#) Introduction to Communication Studies

[COMM 1315](#) Public Speaking

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses

II. Major Requirements: 43 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

Major Preparatory Courses: 19 semester credit hours (16 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum)

[AHTC 1100](#) First Year Seminar (First-time-in-college freshmen are required to take in their first semester)

or [AHTC 2100](#) Student Success Seminar (Transfer students are required to take in their first semester)

[COMM 2301](#) Communication Technology Skills

[COMM 1311](#) Introduction to Communication Studies

or [COMM 1315](#) Public Speaking

[COMM 1320](#) Interpersonal Communication

or [COMM 2314](#) Oral Interpretation

[COMM 2310](#) Introduction to Professional Communication

[COMM 2315](#) Argumentation and Debate

[COMM 2351](#) History and Theory of Communication

Major Core Courses: 21 semester credit hours

[COMM 3340](#) Team Dynamics

[COMM 3350](#) Intercultural Communication

[COMM 3352](#) Media and Culture

[COMM 3353](#) Nonverbal Communication

[COMM 4314](#) Persuasion and Interpersonal Influence

[COMM 4360](#) Communication Ethics

or [ATCM 4384](#) Ethics in New Media, Technology, and Communication

[COMM 4370](#) Communication and Leadership

or [COMM 4371](#) Communication and Professionalism

Advanced Research Requirement: 3 semester credit hours

[COMM 3310](#) Research Methods in Communication Studies

Internship or Capstone Requirement: 3 semester credit hours

[COMM 4398](#) Capstone

or [COMM 4399](#) Communication Internship

III. Elective Requirements: 35 semester credit hours

Major Prescribed Electives: 18 semester credit hours

Students may choose 18 semester credit hours from any of the following courses.

[AMS 3350](#) Crisis Communication

[ATCM 3323](#) Reading in a Networked Era

[ATCM 3325](#) Global Media Cultures

[ATCM 3388](#) Social Influence and Persuasive Design

[AMS 4304](#) Communication in America

[ATCM 4386](#) Journalism in the Networked Age

[ATCM 4388](#) Political Communication

[COMM 2335](#) Communication and Popular Culture

[COMM 3302](#) Graphics and Images in Professional Communication

[COMM 3303](#) Professional Communication in the Career Fields

[COMM 3320](#) Readers' Theater

[COMM 3321](#) Professional and Technical Presentations

[COMM 3322](#) Relational Communication

[COMM 3325](#) Advanced Oral Interpretation

[COMM 3330](#) Public Address and the American Presidency

[COMM 3360](#) TV and Radio Announcing

[COMM 3342](#) Advanced Topics in Communication

[COMM 4303](#) Advanced Editing

or [RHET 4303](#) Advanced Editing

[COMM 4305](#) Communication and Media Law

[COMM 4320](#) Communicating for the World Wide Web

[COMM 4330](#) Digital Media and the 21st Century

[COMM 4341](#) Information Design and Usability

[COMM 4352](#) Digital Advocacy: Strategies for Influence

[COMM 4353](#) Political Discourse in a Digital Era

[COMM 4355](#) Organizational Communication

[COMM 4362](#) Communicating in the World of AI

[COMM 4365](#) Storytelling in Professional Contexts

[COMM 4375](#) Professional Communication in Medicine

[COMM 4395](#) Communication in International Contexts

[COMM 4380](#) Communication in Japan

[FILM 2332](#) Understanding Film

[FILM 3321](#) Film in Historical Context

[FILM 3325](#) Film Authorship

[FILM 3326](#) World Cinema

[RHET 4302](#) Advanced Writing and Research

[RHET 4310](#) Topics in Editing and Publishing

[VPAS 4310](#) Entertainment Law

Free Electives: 17 semester credit hours

Both upper- and lower-division courses may be used as electives.

Concentration Option (15 semester credit hours and 2 semester credit hours in Free Electives)

Professional and Technical Communication Concentration: 15 semester credit hours

[COMM 3302](#) Graphics and Images in Professional Communication

[COMM 3303](#) Professional Communication in the Career Fields

or [COMM 3321](#) Professional and Technical Presentations

[COMM 4303](#) Advanced Editing

or [RHET 4303](#) Advanced Editing

or [RHET 4302](#) Advanced Writing and Research

[COMM 4341](#) Information Design and Usability

[COMM 4355](#) Organizational Communication

Digital Media Studies Concentration: 15 semester credit hours

[COMM 2335](#) Communication and Popular Culture

[COMM 3360](#) TV and Radio Announcing

[COMM 4320](#) Communicating for the World Wide Web

or [COMM 4330](#) Digital Media and the 21st Century

[COMM 4353](#) Political Discourse in a Digital Era

or [COMM 4352](#) Digital Advocacy: Strategies for Influence

[COMM 4362](#) Communicating in the World of AI

or [COMM 4365](#) Storytelling in Professional Contexts

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

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